
NorthLink VPN — Setup & Usage Guide

Northwind Traders, Inc. | Information Technology | Last Updated: March 2026 | Version 2.3 | Policy Owner: IT Infrastructure Lead

1. Overview

All remote access to Northwind Traders' internal systems must go through the Company's managed VPN, NorthLink VPN (powered by GlobalProtect). This guide covers installation, connection, and troubleshooting.

2. Supported Devices & Operating Systems

- Windows 10 / 11 (Company-managed laptops only)
- macOS 13 (Ventura) or later
- iOS 16+ and Android 12+ (via the NorthLink mobile app, view-only access)

3. Installation

3.1 Windows / macOS

- Open the Company Software Portal from the Start Menu or Self Service (macOS).
- Search for "NorthLink VPN" and click Install.
- Restart your device when prompted to complete driver installation.
- Launch NorthLink VPN from the system tray or menu bar.

3.2 Mobile

Install "NorthLink VPN" from the Company's Mobile Device Management (MDM) app catalog. Sign in with your Company SSO credentials when prompted.

4. Connecting

- Open the NorthLink VPN client.
- Enter portal address: `vpn.northwindtraders.example`
- Authenticate with your Company username, password, and a push notification approval via the Okta Verify app (MFA is required for every connection).
- A green status indicator confirms an active, secure connection.

5. Split Tunneling Policy

NorthLink VPN uses split tunneling: only traffic destined for internal Company resources (e.g., *.corp.northwindtraders.example, internal file shares, and the ERP system) is routed through the VPN tunnel. General internet browsing continues to use your local internet connection directly.

6. Troubleshooting

Issue	Likely Cause	Resolution
Client won't connect	Outdated client version	Reinstall via Software Portal / Self Service
MFA push not received	Okta Verify not signed in	Re-enroll device in Okta Verify
Connects, then drops after ~5 min	Unstable Wi-Fi / captive portal network	Switch networks or use a wired connection
"Certificate error" on connect	System clock out of sync	Sync date/time automatically, then reconnect
Cannot reach internal file share	Split-tunnel routing not applied	Fully disconnect and reconnect the VPN client

7. Support

For issues not resolved above, contact the IT Service Desk: **itsupport@northwindtraders.example**, extension 4357 (HELP), or open a ticket at helpdesk.northwindtraders.example. Standard support hours are Monday–Friday, 7:00 AM–7:00 PM ET, with on-call coverage for VPN outages.